Stellar Development Foundation

PRESS KIT

EXECUTIVE BIOS

Denelle Dixon, CEO and Executive Director
Denelle Dixon is the CEO and Executive Director of the Stellar Development Foundation, a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. She leads the teams that help maintain the Stellar network's codebase, support the communities around Stellar, and advocate on behalf of the network with international stakeholders — work that makes SDF's mission of promoting financial access possible.

Before joining Stellar, Dixon served as COO of Mozilla, one of the most successful mission-driven open-source organizations. During her tenure at Mozilla, she led the organization's business, revenue and policy teams including the ongoing fight for net neutrality and the global effort to ensure that people can control their personal data. She also pushed Mozilla to understand how to partner with commercial entities while staying true to its core mission of openness, innovation, and opportunity on the web. A lawyer by trade, Denelle previously served as a general counsel and legal advisor in private equity and technology.

Throughout her career, Denelle has been a vocal advocate for net neutrality, encryption, the disclosure of vulnerabilities by governments, and greater user choice and control.

Born and raised in Gilroy, California, Dixon holds a Bachelor of Arts in Political Science from University of California, Davis and a Juris Doctor from the University of California, Hastings College of the Law. She currently sits on boards for Airtm, a blockchain and bank-connected digital wallet and peer-to-peer exchange platform, Tala, a financial services platform serving the world's underbanked, MoneyGram International, a leading global financial technology company that connects the world's communities, and Trust and Safety Professional Association, a nonprofit that supports professionals who develop and enforce principles and policies that define acceptable behavior and content online. She was named to the Forbes 50 over 50 list in 2023.

Jed McCaleb, Co-Founder and Chief Architect
Jed McCaleb is co-founder and Chief Architect of the Stellar Development Foundation, a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. In 2014, Jed created Stellar, an open-source blockchain network built to democratize economic participation by making money more fluid, markets more open, and people more empowered.

An early pioneer in decentralized systems and blockchain technology, he created eDonkey2000 which became one of the largest file-sharing networks in its time. He later

created Mt. Gox, the first bitcoin exchange, which was subsequently sold and re-coded by its current owners. He is also a co-founder of Ripple.

Jed's devoted his career to developing and leveraging technology that promotes inclusion and transparency.

Jed recently launched astera.org, a 501c3 non-profit dedicated to researching and fostering high leverage technology that can improve the wellbeing, prosperity and quality of life for all people. It seeks to further scientific progress particularly in areas that are impractical to explore in a business or academic setting.

David Mazieres, Co-Founder and Chief Scientist
David Mazières is a professor of Computer Science at Stanford University, where he leads the Secure Computer Systems research group and co-directs the Center for Blockchain Research and Future Digital Currency Initiative. His research interests include Operating Systems and Distributed Systems, with a particular focus on security. He is also a co-founder of Intrinsic, Inc. and Stellar Development Foundation.

Candace Kelly, Chief Legal & Policy Officer
Candace Kelly is the Chief Legal and Policy Officer of the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. She leads SDF's legal team, that is responsible for all of SDF's legal affairs and the policy team that is focused on bridging the gap between the public and private sectors and fostering dialogue with global regulators and policymakers.

Prior to joining SDF, Candace worked for Uber Technologies, Inc., where she held a variety of positions, helping to navigate the company's response to regulatory investigations and advising on safety, security, privacy, consumer protection, and law enforcement response.

Candace brings many years of legal experience to SDF, most notably her 17 year career at the United States Department of Justice (DOJ), where she held positions as a legal and policy advisor on national security, criminal, and civil rights issues in leadership offices in Washington D.C. and as a prosecutor in the Northern District of California. During her time with DOJ, she also served as Special Counsel for National Security for the Director of the FBI. She holds a Bachelor of Arts in East Asian Studies from Williams College and a Juris Doctor from University of California (UC), Hastings College of the Law.

Candace is a member of the Janet Reno Endowment Advisory Committee at the Center for Juvenile Justice Reform at the Georgetown University McCourt School of Public Policy, and an Advisory Board Member for the UC Hastings Center for Business Law.

Justin Rice, Vice President of Ecosystem
Justin Rice is the Vice President of Ecosystem at the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. In this role, he represents developers building on the Stellar network and coordinates

members of the Stellar ecosystem, with an ultimate focus on growth, development and ongoing health of that system.

Prior to his current role, Justin worked in Stellar product development, where he helped build the StellarX exchange, which utilizes Stellar open-source technology. He holds a Bachelors of Arts degree in Comparative Literature from Harvard University.

Jason Chlipala, Chief Business Officer
Jason Chlipala is the Chief Business Officer at the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. At SDF, he oversees the strategic direction and execution of SDF's partnerships and investment activities. Jason also currently serves as a member of the Commodity Futures Trading Commission's (CFTC) Global Market Advisory Committee, which guides the Commission on issues that affect the integrity and competitiveness of U.S. markets and U.S. firms engaged in global business.

Prior to joining SDF, Jason was the COO of Interstellar, where he worked on all areas of business operations. Jason also previously led teams of engineers, data scientists, and designers in building custom solutions to data problems in his business development role at Palantir Technologies. Before moving to the technology space, Jason began his professional career as a tax and corporate attorney in New York. He holds a Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics from Cornell and a Juris Doctor from Yale Law School.

Jordan Edelstein, Chief Marketing Officer
Jordan Edelstein is the Chief Marketing Officer at the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. At SDF, Jordan leads marketing efforts on behalf of the Stellar network.

Jordan has a demonstrated history of driving both stand-alone products and persistent live services via brand-driven and performance marketing on a global scale. He has built marketing and customer service teams from the ground up, as well as managed large cross-functional teams while maintaining a focus on potential and existing consumers. Prior to joining Stellar, Jordan worked in the videogame industry, partnering closely with developers in bringing some of the industry’s biggest titles to market for Electronic Arts, Kabam, and 21st Century Fox. He holds a Bachelors of Arts in German and European Studies from Amherst College and an MBA in Marketing, Finance & Organizational Behavior from the Northwestern University Kellogg School of Management.

Jordan sits on the Board of Trustees for St. Paul’s Episcopal School in Oakland.

Tomer Weller, Vice President of Product
Tomer is the Vice President of Product at the Stellar Development Foundation, a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. At SDF, he focuses on technology strategy and the future of the Stellar protocol.

Previously he served as SDF's VP of Tech Strategy, focusing on the future of the Stellar protocol, and as Director of Partner Engineering, where he led an engineering team working closely with selected financial institutions on defining interoperability standards and building the supporting tools to grow the Stellar network. Tomer has been part of the Stellar ecosystem since 2017, has led a plethora of partner integrations and contributed to projects such as Horizon and StellarX. He holds a MSc degree in Media Arts and Sciences from the Massachusetts institute of Technology And a BSc degree from the Hebrew University in Jerusalem.

Nicolas Barry, Chief Technology Officer
Nicolas Barry is the CTO of the Stellar Development Foundation, a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology.

As someone who likes to tinker with software and tackle hard distributed problems, Nicolas is excited by turning potential technology into something practical that benefits many. He previously helped build large-scale systems at Microsoft and Salesforce. Nicolas holds an MS in Computer Science and Mathematics from ENSEEIHT in Toulouse, France.

Lisa MacNew, Vice President of People
Lisa MacNew is the Vice President of People of the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. At SDF, Lisa leads SDF's strategic people initiatives including all aspects of talent acquisition, people management and company culture. Lisa has more than 15 years of HR experience scaling various startups in culture development and employee experience. Prior to joining SDF, Lisa held HR leadership roles at POPSUGAR, Weebly, Leanplum and most recently Roadster.

Lauren Thorbjornsen, Chief of Staff, Vice President
Lauren Thorbjornsen is Chief of Staff and Vice President at the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF), a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. She leads SDF's strategy, including developing the annual strategy and vision, designing and overseeing the strategic planning process, and running impact initiatives and special projects. Lauren started her career in political campaigns, which led her to serve on the White House Communications team under President Obama. She went on to work internationally at the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD) on a range of policy issues such as migration, education, and economic development. Before joining SDF, she led partner communications at Salesforce, helping tell the story of the ecosystem of businesses that build and implement on the platform. She holds a master's degree in International Relations from the London School of Economics and Political Science and a bachelor's degree in Journalism from the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign.

NETWORK AND COMPANY OVERVIEWS

Stellar
Stellar is more than a blockchain. Powered by a decentralized, fast, scalable, and uniquely sustainable network made for financial products and services and a thriving and passionate ecosystem that includes a non-profit organization driven by a mission, Stellar is paving the path to unlock the world's economic potential through blockchain technology. Built with speed and low costs in mind, the Stellar network provides builders and financial institutions worldwide a platform to issue assets, and to send and convert currencies in real time creating real world utility. Founded in 2014, the Stellar Development Foundation (SDF) supports the continued development and growth of the Stellar network and also serves the ecosystem of NGOs, corporations, universities, small businesses, governments, and solo entrepreneurs building on the Stellar network through tooling, funding and strategic collaborations. Together, Stellar is where blockchain meets the real world.

The Stellar Network
The Stellar network is a decentralized, fast, scalable, and uniquely sustainable blockchain built for financial products and services. It offers builders smart contracts functionality and a protocol optimized for payments, with a design intended to keep fees low and to provide transaction speeds that can scale with increased adoption. Financial institutions and innovators worldwide issue assets and settle payments on the Stellar network, which has processed billions operations with millions of accounts since the network was first launched.

Stellar Development Foundation
The Stellar Development Foundation (SDF) is a non-profit organization focused on working with and supporting changemakers to create equitable access to the global financial system through blockchain technology. SDF provides grants, investments, funding, and other awards to builders and organizations. SDF also develops resources and tooling on the Stellar network to help unlock real world utility. As a nonprofit foundation, SDF puts the health of the Stellar network and the Stellar ecosystem and its mission above all else.
For more information, visit https://stellar.org/foundation.

Social

Follow us on Twitter @stellarorg and LinkedIn at Stellar Development Foundation

Media Contact

media@stellar.org

Logos and Brand Policy

Download Stellar and Stellar Development Foundation logo variants here. Please refer to our brand policy for guidelines on usage.

STELLAR TIMELINE

2014
Stellar network and Stellar Development Foundation created.

2015
Stellar Consensus Protocol becomes the consensus mechanism for the Stellar network and David Mazieres joins SDF.

2016
Stellar Development Foundation builds strategic regional partnerships in Nigeria and the Philippines.

2017
The Stellar network sees some initial growth, with daily active users growing from 300 to 14,000, and total accounts growing from 17,000 to 140,000.
SDF introduces a partnership grant program.

2018
The Stellar network grows to 2.5 million accounts as new apps and asset issuers join the ecosystem.

2019
SDF hires CEO and Executive Director, Denelle Dixon.
SDF opened its New York City office.
SDF hosts its first Meridian in Mexico City.
SDF publishes its Mandate for the first time

2020
Stellar network has surpassed 1.5 billion operations since launch.
SDF creates the Enterprise Fund and invests a total of $9.265 million in its first year.
SDF hosts its first virtual Meridian.
Vibrant launches in Argentina.

2021
The Stellar network surpasses 2 billion operations since launch
AMM functionality launched on the Stellar network.
MoneyGram announces partnership with SDF to develop a first-of-its-kind service for cashing in and out of crypto.
SDF grows to more than 100 employees.
SDF Enterprise Fund grows to more than $80.250 million invested.

2022
SDF announces the development of smart contracts with the launch of Project Jump Cannon.
MoneyGram launches global cash out service on the Stellar network.
The Stellar network surpasses 7 million accounts.

Vibrant 2.0 launches in the United States and Argentina.
SDF San Francisco office moves to Brannan Street.
SDF hosts fourth Meridian in Rome.
Stellar Aid Assist launches with UNHCR to disburse humanitarian aid in Ukraine.

2023
SDF launches $100 million Soroban Adoption Fund.
Franklin Templeton launches global money market fund on the Stellar network.
SDF unveils rebrand and collaboration with Idris Elba.
SDF hosts fifth Meridian in Madrid.

2024
Smart contracts come to Stellar.
Stellar surpasses 8 million accounts and 15 billion operations.